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Debt Payoff Planner

Snowball and avalanche, plus the things real contracts have: early-payoff fees, lock-in periods, 0% deals with a deadline, and debts that are already behind.

FOUR ORDERS

compared

debt-free date, interest and fees side by side

EARLY-PAYOFF FEE

worth it?

fee vs the interest you'd save

0% DEALS

deadline

warns before back-interest hits

FROM THE EXAMPLE DEBTS · $1,500 A MONTH

Avalanche	highest APR first	$1,599 interest	MISSES 0% DEADLINE
Smart	behind → deadlines → APR	$1,679 interest	CLEARS IT IN TIME
Car loan	$400 fee to pay off early	saves about $917	FEE CHECK
Personal loan	rule: not sure	minimums only	ASK LENDER

STEP 1 · GET YOUR OWN COPY

OPEN MY PLANNER →

docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1aAwr-2Z8s7axpqPHufyJ8z0-JK3JMnx0_E8O2Xu3GRE/copy

Click the button, then choose **Make a copy**. The copy is yours, saved in your own Google Drive. Nobody else can see what you enter, including us.

HOW IT WORKS

Ready in about ten minutes

1

Make your copy

Open the link on page 1 while signed in to Google and press **Make a copy**.

2

List your debts

On **My Debts** you only need name, balance, APR and minimum payment. Everything else is optional: leave it blank if it doesn't apply.

3

Set your plan

On **Plan**, enter what you can pay toward all debts each month and pick an order. Compare all four.

Colour code

Columns with a **BLUE header** are yours to fill in. Columns with an **ORANGE header** calculate themselves: leave them alone. Example rows are marked (sample): overwrite or clear them.

The four payoff orders

Smart	Behind-on-payments first, then 0%/deferred-interest deadlines, then highest APR. If minimums take 35%+ of your income, it frees up monthly money first.
Avalanche	Highest APR first. Usually the least interest on paper.
Snowball	Smallest balance first. Quick wins.
Cash-flow	The debt whose minimum is largest compared with its balance first, so monthly money frees up fastest.

On your phone

Install the free Google Sheets app and open the copy from your Drive. Dark mode looks washed out? Tap ⋮ › **View in light theme**.

Print and color

The **Print** tab turns your plan into a one-page color-in tracker: your debts in payoff order, the real amount in every box and the month you'll reach it. Change your debts and it updates. File › Print.

Prefer Excel?

In your Google copy choose File › Download › Microsoft Excel (.xlsx). Everything calculates.

THE PARTS OTHER TRACKERS SKIP

Real contracts have rules

Early payoff rule

Allowed, no fee extra money can go here any time. Blank counts as this.

Allowed with a fee enter the fee and when it ends. The sheet compares the fee with the interest you'd save by paying early. Worth it: extra goes in now and the fee is added to your totals. Not worth it: extra waits until the fee ends.

Locked until a date minimums only until that date.

Not sure minimums only. Ask your lender, then change the rule.

0% and promo deals

Enter when the promo ends and the APR after it: the rate switches on that date. If the deal has **deferred interest** (back-interest from day one if you don't clear it in time), mark it Yes. Smart pays these off before the deadline, and every order that misses a deadline gets a warning.

Checks on the Plan tab

- Your monthly amount is less than your minimums.
- A minimum payment doesn't cover the interest (that debt grows).
- Some debts are locked or uncertain.
- A deferred-interest deadline is missed in the order you picked.

QUESTIONS

FAQ

Is my information private?

Yes. Your copy lives in your own Google Drive. We never see it, and nothing is sent anywhere.

My currency isn't dollars.

It works in any currency: just use the same one everywhere. Amounts have no symbol on purpose.

Dates show in another language.

File › Settings › Locale, pick your country. Dates and number formats follow it.

How many debts?

Up to 12. Blank rows anywhere in the table are fine. The plan runs up to 30 years.

Why is my debt-free date different from my lender's?

The planner works out interest monthly at APR ÷ 12 and doesn't include back-interest, late fees or rate changes you haven't entered. Your lender's statement is the final word.

Estimates only, not financial, legal or tax advice. Contracts differ by country and lender. For personal use only: please don't share or resell the template link.